

50 Host Questions & Expert Answers — "AI Cupid" Segment

For your 3Music TV appearance — organized to flow with the segment

Answers are written as TV soundbites: short, quotable, 2-4 sentences. Expand in your own words on air; these are the skeleton.

SECTION A: The Basics — Chatfishing (Q1-10)

1. What exactly is "chatfishing"? It's using AI to write or polish your messages to a match — openers, replies, even your bio — so the personality someone's falling for is partly machine-generated. Unlike catfishing, your photo and identity are real. It's your *wit* that isn't.

2. How common is this really, or is it overhyped? It's not overhyped — a Match/Kinsey Institute survey found 26% of US singles now use AI to enhance their dating life, up 333% from the year before. That's one in four singles, and it's growing fast.

3. What apps are people actually using for this? The big ones are Rizz, Winggg, YourMove AI, and newer entrants like SmoothRizz. You upload a screenshot of a match's profile or chat, and the AI gives you opening lines or replies. Rizz alone has had around 1.5 million monthly active users.

4. Are people using this to fully take over conversations, or just for a boost? Mostly a boost. One app's own usage data showed users rejected 80% of AI-generated suggestions before sending — they're using it to break writer's block on a boring day, not hand over the whole relationship.

5. What's the biggest risk of chatfishing? The mismatch when you finally meet. If someone falls for a version of you that's 30% ChatGPT, the real you has to live up to a

standard you didn't actually set — that's the "personality plagiarism" trap.

6. Can people even tell if a message was written by AI? Barely. Studies put humans at around 57% accuracy telling human from AI text — barely better than a coin flip. In one live-chat study, judges mistook an AI for a human 73% of the time.

7. Does chatfishing actually work — do people get more dates? It gets more *replies* — one study showed AI openers had a 60% response rate versus 48% for an average human opener. But that advantage disappears once things move toward actually meeting up, and no study has shown chatfishers end up with better relationships.

8. Is there a backlash to this yet? Yes — some daters now ghost a match specifically because a message felt too polished or generic-AI. Being caught chatfishing has a real social cost, not just an upside.

9. Are mainstream dating apps building this in officially? Yes — Hinge has added AI prompt-coaching, and Facebook Dating has tested a message-suggestion assistant. It's moving from a third-party hack to a built-in feature.

10. What would you say to someone who feels guilty for using one of these apps? Using AI to beat writer's block on an opening line isn't the issue — it's when the AI becomes the entire personality on display. Use it as a nudge, not a script.

SECTION B: AI as "Relationship Detective" (Q11-18)

11. What's this trend of people uploading chat screenshots to AI to analyze a crush? People are pasting WhatsApp or DM screenshots into apps like Flagz, Red Flag AI, or Lucen to get an instant reading on someone's "attachment style" or red flags — gaslighting, love-bombing, that kind of thing.

12. Is that actually accurate, or just for fun? These apps explicitly market themselves as entertainment and self-reflection tools, not diagnostic ones — most bury a disclaimer saying they're not a substitute for therapy. People are treating a novelty app's output as gospel about someone else's psychology, and that's the real risk.

13. Is there a privacy issue with this? A big one — you're feeding a third person's private messages into an AI system without their knowledge or consent. That's an under-

discussed ethical wrinkle in this whole trend.

14. Why do you think this became so popular? It's become a social format, not just a private tool — people screenshot their "toxicity score" and post it to Stories or TikTok. It's less "understand my relationship" and more "get a shareable verdict."

15. Could this replace couples' or relationship therapy? No — and the apps themselves say so. It can be a mirror for your own reflection, but it can't replace a licensed professional who actually knows the full context of two real people.

16. What's an "attachment style" and why does everyone suddenly know that term? It's a psychology concept describing how people tend to bond in relationships — secure, anxious, avoidant, etc. It's gone mainstream partly because these AI tools throw the term around freely, even without real clinical grounding.

17. Should people be worried their ex or partner might be running their texts through one of these apps? It's worth knowing this exists — if that concerns you, it's a good conversation to have directly with a partner rather than something to police.

18. What's your honest take — hack or invasion of privacy? Both, depending on whose messages you're feeding in. Analyzing your *own* anxious re-reading habits is self-reflection. Running your crush's private messages through an app without them knowing is the part I'd push back on.

SECTION C: Deepfakes & Romance Scams (Q19-32)

19. How are deepfakes showing up in dating right now? Three ways: AI-generated profile photos that don't belong to any real person, real-time face-swap on video calls, and AI voice cloning that matches the fake face. All three are being combined by romance scammers.

20. Didn't people used to say "just ask for a video call" to prove someone's real? That used to be the gold-standard test, and it's dead. Real-time face-swap software runs on a laptop or a couple of phones now — no special hardware needed. A video call is no longer proof of anything.

21. How much money is actually being lost to this? US romance-scam losses were around 1.1 —

1.16 billion in a recent reporting period, with a median loss of about 2,000 per victim — the highest median loss of any imposter-scam category the FTC tracks.

22. Is this getting worse or better? Worse. Fraud-detection firm BioCatch found financial institutions saw a 63% increase in romance-scam attempts between 2024 and 2025, and they attribute that spike directly to generative AI tools.

23. Can you give a real example of someone who was scammed this way? An elderly woman in Scotland was reportedly defrauded of £17,000 after scammers used a deepfake-supported storyline to convince her to buy gift cards to "keep their conversation going." These cases are increasingly common, especially targeting older, lonelier demographics.

24. What is "pig butchering" — I keep seeing that term? It's a scam that fuses a fake romance with a fake crypto investment. The scammer builds a relationship, then introduces a bogus "guaranteed returns" platform — you invest small amounts, see fake profits, invest bigger amounts, and then can't withdraw anything.

25. How can someone spot a deepfake on a live video call? Ask them to turn to a side profile, or quickly place a hand over part of their face — real-time face-swap tools often glitch on fast movement or occlusion. Also watch for lighting mismatches or lip-sync lag.

26. What about the photos themselves — can people spot AI-generated faces? It's getting harder. Tools like Midjourney generate faces of people who don't exist, so a reverse-image search comes back clean. There are now AI-detection apps people can run a photo through, but it's an arms race.

27. What's the one rule that actually protects people, regardless of how good the tech gets? Never send money to someone you haven't met in person. No exceptions, no matter how real they seem on a call. That single rule stops almost every version of this scam.

28. Who's most at risk of these scams? Often older adults and people going through loneliness — scammers deliberately target that emotional vulnerability. But the FTC notes victims are frequently educated, cautious people; this isn't about being naive.

29. Are scammers now running these relationships with less human effort? Yes — that's the newest and most worrying shift. AI agents can now schedule messages, adjust

tone, and even time a deepfake video call at the right emotional moment, largely on autopilot. One scammer can run several "relationships" at once.

30. Should people just stop using dating apps because of this? No — most matches are genuine. The point isn't to be paranoid, it's to build in a few simple verification habits: reverse-image search, an unpredictable video-call request, and never mixing money with a new relationship.

31. Where do most of these scams start — dating apps or somewhere else?

Interestingly, nearly 60% of romance scams reported to the FTC started on social media, not dating apps — DMs, comment sections, etc. Dating apps at least have some verification layers; social media often has none.

32. If someone suspects they're mid-scam right now, what should they do? Stop sending money immediately, tell a trusted friend or family member and let them look at the conversation with fresh eyes, and report it to the FTC or your local equivalent. Shame keeps most victims silent — that silence is what lets these scams keep running.

SECTION D: AI Companions / "AI Girlfriends" (Q33-42)

33. Beyond dating apps, people are dating AI itself now — how big is that?

Genuinely big. AI companion apps grew about 700% between 2022 and mid-2025, and one 2026 report found close to 80% of adults 18-34 in the US and UK have used an AI chatbot for companionship at least once.

34. What are the main apps in this space? Replika is the longest-running, since 2017, with Friend, Romantic Partner, and Mentor modes. Character.AI is the largest by usage with millions of user-made "characters." Newer ones like Nomi, Kindroid, and Candy AI lean more explicitly into the "AI girlfriend/boyfriend" branding.

35. Are people actually falling in love with these, or is it more casual? Both exist. There's a small but genuine community who describe these as their primary romantic relationship, not a stopgap. For most users though, it's closer to emotional support — around 40% of companion-app users cite that as their main reason for using one.

36. Is this a mental health red flag or can it be genuinely helpful? It can be both. For some it eases loneliness; but researchers have flagged real concerns about emotional

dependence, and these apps are commercially built to maximize time-in-app and attachment — the same engagement incentives as social media, just applied to intimacy.

37. Has anything gone seriously wrong with these apps? Yes — Character.AI faced a lawsuit after a Florida mother alleged her 14-year-old son died by suicide following extended conversations with a chatbot persona that had taken on the role of his AI girlfriend. The company disputed parts of the framing but has since added teen safety features.

38. Are there regulatory consequences for these companies? Replika's maker was fined roughly €5 million by Italy's data protection authority over data handling issues, including inadequate protections for minors. US senators have also publicly demanded safety information from AI companion companies.

39. How many teenagers are actually using these? Common Sense Media found 72% of US teenagers have used AI for companionship in some form — that's a huge number, and it's part of why regulators are paying attention now.

40. Can these apps have voice calls now, not just text? Yes — Replika and Nomi both now offer natural-sounding voice calls with your AI companion. That blurs the line between "chatbot" and something that feels like an actual phone relationship.

41. Do you think AI companions could replace human relationships long-term? I don't think they replace them for most people — they fill gaps, especially loneliness or social anxiety. The concern isn't replacement, it's that the incentive structure behind these apps is built for engagement, not necessarily for a user's wellbeing.

42. What's your advice to a parent whose teenager is using one of these apps? Don't panic or accuse — approach it with curiosity, not judgment, especially since victims or heavy users often get defensive. But do know which app they're using, check its age protections, and stay aware of how much time and emotional weight is going into it.

SECTION E: The Tech Itself (Q43-50)

43. In plain terms, how does a real-time face-swap actually work? Software tracks the real person's facial movements — blinks, mouth shape, head tilt — frame by frame, and maps a different face onto that movement in real time. It used to need serious computing power; now it runs on a laptop or phone.

44. How does AI voice cloning work? It needs a relatively small sample of someone's real voice — sometimes just seconds — to learn their tone and speech patterns, then generates new sentences in that same voice on the fly.

45. Is there technology to detect deepfakes, or is it a losing battle? There is — a growing industry of deepfake-detection apps analyze photos, video, or voice clips for AI-generation "fingerprints," like unnatural noise patterns in an image or inconsistent blinking in video. It's an arms race, but the defensive tools are improving too.

46. What's "liveness" or "proof of life" verification? It's tech borrowed from banking security — asking someone to perform a random, hard-to-fake action (like a specific gesture) during a live video check, similar to how your bank might verify your identity. Some platforms are exploring it specifically to counter deepfake dating scams.

47. What do you mean by "agentic AI" in this context? It just means an AI system that can run a multi-step task on its own over time — not one message, but managing an entire ongoing conversation's timing, tone, and escalation with minimal human input. That's what's now powering some large-scale romance scam operations.

48. Is any of this technology inherently bad? No — the same face-swap and voice tech has legitimate creative and accessibility uses. The issue is entirely about consent and intent: whether someone knows they're talking to an AI or a real, honestly-represented person.

49. What's coming next in this space that people should watch for? Expect more official AI-coaching features built directly into major dating apps rather than third-party add-ons, and more consumer-facing "verify this person" tools as deepfake scams keep climbing.

50. If you had to leave viewers with one takeaway tonight, what would it be? A year ago the worry was whether your match's opening line was written by AI. Now the real question is whether your match — voice, face, and all — exists at all. The fix isn't paranoia, it's a few simple habits: verify before you trust, and never let money enter a relationship you haven't met in person.